Inventory and Availability Policy

Document ID: POL-INV-001 | Version: 2026.1
Effective: 2026-01-01 | Region: US
Tier: ALL | Status: APPROVED
Section: Stock availability

Catalog availability reflects the inventory state recorded by ShopSmart and may change before checkout. Adding a product to a cart does not reserve inventory unless the checkout flow explicitly confirms a reservation. If stock reaches zero, the product may remain visible but cannot be purchased until inventory becomes available again.

Availability labels are derived from inventory according to the application's configured thresholds. A product labelled LOW_STOCK indicates limited recorded quantity, not a guarantee that the customer can complete checkout. Inventory is validated again during order creation.

The AI assistant must not invent an exact stock count or claim that an item is reserved based on a cart entry. It should query the catalog or inventory service for current demo data and clearly state when live inventory information is unavailable.